

How is the ocean water rising even tho AI is using our water?

Posted by u/Ok_Spare7598 • 0 points • 14 comments

Saw a video about a nation possibly disappearing because of rising ocean waters but isn't AI using the water or is AI only using clean waters? and even so why can't AI use the ocean water instead

Comments

u/bangbangracer • 1 points • 2026-03-31 14:06 UTC

Ocean water makes bad coolant because it contains a butt load of salt. That salt gums up pipes and speeds up corrosion. It also contains life which causes the same problems.

So cooling uses fresh drinking water. Now this brings in another issue. That cooling either evaporates freshwater off into the water cycle or it goes back as grey water that requires treatment before it goes into reserves.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-03-31 14:03 UTC

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u/squarecir • 1 points • 2026-03-31 14:01 UTC

Why is there more rice on the shelves when I keep eating rice?

u/One_Disaster_5995 • 2 points • 2026-03-31 13:58 UTC

What do you think happens to water after datacenters use it? It doesn't disappear - it is used for cooling and then it gets discharged - or it evaporates and simply rains back down somewhere else on earth.

Datacenters use water for cooling, which in itself is not that big a problem, except if they use drinking water (they dont have to), plus that the warm water they discharge messes with nature around the datacenters.

The oceans rise because part of the water on earth was trapped in ice, and now the ice is melting due to global warming.

u/Bright-Scallin • 1 points • 2026-03-31 13:51 UTC

That question is genuinely hilarious.

Aside from that, the idea that data centers use/waste water is kind of a myth. It's like saying your water-cooled PC uses 1 liter of water per minute... It doesn't; it's a closed system.

But they use an absurd amount of energy cooling that water though.

u/Background_Toe7430 • 7 points • 2026-03-31 13:49 UTC

quick add: datacenter water use is local issue, sea-level rise is global heat + melting land ice.

u/Jim777PS3 • 2 points • 2026-03-31 13:47 UTC

Water is never removed from the planet. Our planet's water cycle is a closed system.

AI Data centers take fresh clean drinking water and use it to cool their computers. This turns the water into steam.

The steam is let off into the air, where it condenses and falls back to the earth as rain.

However most of the earth, its lands, and rivers, lead to the ocean. So this water becomes unusable for drinking, or even for future AI cooling.

This is what people mean when they say AI is using water.

u/Technical-Dress9564 • 1 points • 2026-03-31 13:46 UTC

the ocean is rising mainly because of climate change melting ice caps and thermal expansion, not because of AI. AI doesn't actually "use" water; it's more about the tech being run, and clean water concerns are separate from ocean levels.

u/TheGargageMan • 7 points • 2026-03-31 13:46 UTC

The ocean is rising because the ice is melting somewhere else.

u/KronusIV • 4 points • 2026-03-31 13:45 UTC

Data centers don't destroy water. They just take water that could be used by homes and farms and use it for cooling, pumping a lot of it into the atmosphere. The water still exists, just not where it's needed. Instead it's raining down elsewhere, quite possibly in the ocean.

u/Ghigs • 2 points • 2026-03-31 13:45 UTC

Using water doesn't destroy it. And there is no shortage of fresh water overall. Some areas where people stupidly built big cities in deserts are always short on water.

u/muftak3 • 0 points • 2026-03-31 14:06 UTC

There is an absolute shortage of fresh water worldwide, not just desert regions. Those don't help, but its happening everywhere. The US has had major droughts throughout the country, not just the southwest. A report released in January explains how much is being used and how water requirements will out pace supply very soon.

[Global Water Bankruptcy Report](<https://unu.edu/inweh/news/world-enters-era-of-global-water-bankruptcy>)

u/Pastadseven • 2 points • 2026-03-31 14:06 UTC

> And there is no shortage of fresh water overall. Some areas where people stupidly built big cities in deserts are always short on water.

There are shortages of freshwater. Everywhere. Yes, even in your local temperate city that sits on

a river. Potable water has to be made *available.* Data centers exacerbate this by drawing on that water unnecessarily. Very few major cities can exist without drawing water from elsewhere, not just “stupid cities.”

u/Ghigs • 1 points • 2026-03-31 14:33 UTC

It falls from the sky for free and we throw most of it away by dumping it in rivers that flow to the ocean.

It's so plentiful that it's nearly free in most areas. That's not a "shortage" of water. If anything there's a shortage of infrastructure.

u/Pastadseven • 11 points • 2026-03-31 13:44 UTC

Cooling uses freshwater because saltwater is corrosive as fuck and expensive to desalinate. AI uses evaporative cooling, which loses freshwater to atmo, which is what we say when we say it's being used up.